

11.5 THE PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE AND THE PAST SIMPLE

The past simple is used to talk about something that happened at a definite time. The present perfect is used when a particular time is not specified.

A specific date, 2010, is given, so the past simple is used.

Have you ever been to France?

Yes, I **visited** Paris in 2010.



2010



NOW

There's no specific date, so the present perfect is used.

Yes, I **have visited** Paris many times.



2003



2008



2010



2014



NOW

FURTHER EXAMPLES

PAST SIMPLE

I **saw** a great movie last week.



Jo **didn't climb** Mount Fuji last year.



Madison **ate** too much last night.



PRESENT PERFECT

I **haven't seen** that movie.



Saki **has climbed** Mount Fuji twice.



Jack **hasn't eaten** curry before.



11.6 THE PRESENT PERFECT IN US ENGLISH

US English often uses the past simple when UK English would use the present perfect.



No dessert for me! I **ate** too much. (US)

No dessert for me! I **'ve eaten** too much. (UK)



I can't find my passport. **Did you see** it? (US)

I can't find my passport. **Have you seen** it? (UK)